Oscar Byrne

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Motivation

I'm a curious and driven developer who has recently started experimenting in earnest with web development. I am planning on emigrating to Canada in about 6 months (although this is dependent on securing a VISA), so I am looking for shorter-term work where I can continue learning new skills - something which I love!

Work Experience

Cisco, Software Engineer

January 2016 - July 2016

Acano was acquired by Cisco for $700m, after which I was moved to a new agile team to develop a next-gen, **Android-based** product running on custom hardware. This involved building an **entirely new testing environment** using industry-standard technologies.

Accomplishments:

- Planned our overarching **test strategy**, reviewing existing technologies and methodologies.
- Constructed an all-**hardware test lab**, including network provisions and remote power switching (there was a risk that early prototypes would burst into flames if left on overnight!)
- Developed a **custom test runner** for our product able to: prepare the hardware for testing, run tests in parallel and collect useful reports including screenshots. This involved hacking in Gradle, Jtest and Python.
- Developed a **continuous-integration** environment using technologies including: Jenkins, Phabricator and Docker.

Acano, QA Engineer

October 2014 – January 2016

I joined the QA team at Acano in the first wave of graduate recruits. I initially worked on manual testing and writing test plans, but soon graduated to developing frameworks for **automated tests**.

Accomplishments:

- Constantly required to learn **new technologies** and ways of working.
- Contributed to intranet website written using Django, including writing new **HTML templates** and data models.
- Designed and **developed the framework** for running automated tests on the next generation of our client software. There was no automation of the client prior to this, and some existing systems had to be rewritten to accommodate the new module. The framework is a 'write once run anywhere' system that runs tests on multiple platforms, including: **Android, iOS, Windows, Mac** and various **web browsers**.

DESY, Summer Studentship Computing Program

July 2013 – August 2013

A 2 month paid internship working with the world's **most brilliant X-ray source** at DESY (Germany's answer to CERN). Aside from a minor project involving RPC technologies, I cut my teeth on Python developing an automated toolchain for processing tomographic images.

Hobbyist Portfolio

Personal Website

https://github.com/oscarbyrne/website

I have developed an (extremely minimal) personal website which is **mobile-optimised** with responsive CSS, and makes use of **semantic HTML** tags.

Online CV

https://github.com/oscarbyrne/cv

This CV is also available as a web document generated using the reStructuredText syntax. This project involved extensive **CSS** work to get the web page closely mirroring the PDF version, including the use of **unusual language constructs** (or hacks!) which were required given the limitations of the ReST language.

Python Meta-Programming

https://github.com/oscarbyrne/notes
https://github.com/oscarbyrne/vikings

I am interested in developing beautiful interfaces, to the point where they almost become programming languages in their own right. Python's high capacity for metaprogramming makes this possible. I have **2 projects** available on my github demonstrating this - 'notes', which is a tool for exploring music theory; and 'vikings', the latest iteration of a modern 'text adventure' game I have been toying with for several years (note this is very much a work in progress).

Education

University of Birmingham, MSci Physics

2010 - 2014

For my fourth year project I became involved with **front-line research** in metamaterials, and contributed to a project which was presented as part of the PIERS conference 2014 in China. I chose mostly computing-related modules, including:

- **Teaching in Schools,** for which I spent 11 weeks teaching in a Primary school
- **Image Processing,** which mostly focused on algorithms
- **Computational Modelling of Physical Systems,** for which I implemented a dynamical billiards simulation using C++

Sir Thomas Rich's School, Gloucester

A levels:	A*, A, B, C
AS levels:	B
GCSEs:	4 A* passes, 5 As and 2 Bs

Other Interests

- Producing electronic music - I've assembled a **home studio** which I use to make hip hop
- Rock climbing

References

References are available on request